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## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Mansfield Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.mansfieldclassicalacademy.org/>

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**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Mansfield Classical Academy (Mansfield, OH 44905) presents a clearly Christian, classical identity centered on parent-led formation within a Christ-focused, "classical Latin scholae" framework. Public materials emphasize a biblically integrated, Creator-centered approach and collaboration with parents, with explicit emphasis on character formation and leadership development. This alignment places the school squarely within the classical family of schools in spirit, though publicly documented details about explicit Great Books study, Socratic pedagogy, or a full Great Conversation culture are less evident in the visible site copy. Overall, by the classical rubric, the school demonstrates strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and a clear Parents & Community orientation, with meaningful elements of Curriculum and Purpose, but more explicit signaling of Pedagogy and Faculty clarity would push the school toward a fuller CLASSICAL designation.

- Core positives: Christ-centered, Creator-focused theology; parent-led formation; PK-12 classical identity; ACCS affiliation; explicit Latin-scholae framing; leadership formation as a stated goal.
- Gaps to tighten for a fuller CLASSICAL rating: explicit Great Books / Great Conversation signals; explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades; a more explicit living-faculty model and classroom pedagogy language; broader "formation through imitation" and visible memory-chanting practices in public materials.

Evidence snippets show the school's explicit religious framing, its emphasis on parent involvement, and its classical-college preparatory tone. See home page philosophy language and ACCS membership for evidence of religious-practical signaling and classical alignment.

The six-category evaluation below follows the classical rubric (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community) using the Positive/Negative keyword frameworks from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document and cross-checking with the Classical Lexicon to quantify signal strength.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

#### Evidence

- Public materials describe Mansfield as "Christ-centered" and note a Biblically guided, parent-led framework; language explicitly mentions "illuminating the Creator in all studies" and fostering "knowledge and enjoyment of God forever." These signals indicate transcendent moral realism and theology-based study in daily practice.
- The ACCS membership emphasizes a classical Christian formation ethos, reinforcing the religious/metaphysical grounding.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; Creator; God; Biblical; theology (implied); sacred orientation through worship/creation language (embedded in the theology-forward phrasing).
- Negative keywords: None evident in the public copy (e.g., no relativism, secular humanism signals observed here).

## Why this rating

- The text demonstrates transcendental moral realism and a theology-integrated academic frame; liturgical/communal practices are not explicitly catalogued, but the language tightens the metaphysical foundations with explicit Christian theism. Thus CLASSICAL for category 1.
- Supporting lexicon alignment: The Classical Lexicon lists truth/goodness/beauty, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, and imago Dei as positive signals; the Mansfield copy directly asserts Creator/-God/Theology language.

Overall rating: CLASSICAL

**Element 2: Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

## Evidence

- The school states a formation-centered aim: “to become free, logical, and imaginative thinkers in preparation for a lifetime of leadership in their homes, congregations, and communities.” This foregrounds character formation and a telos oriented toward leadership and societal influence. The phrasing “under Biblical mandate ... to become free, logical, and imaginative thinkers” signals formation aimed at virtue-wisdom guidance rather than immediate job training.
- The public statement about “illumination of the Creator in all studies” and “chief end ... knowledge and enjoyment of God forever” aligns with a formation telos rather than purely information-transfer, though the emphasis on leadership is explicitly stated.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation; liberal education (implicit through “classical” framing); telos; pursuit of true/good/beautiful (implied by classical aims); great conversation (implicit in classical aims, but not spelled out as a program here).
- Negative keywords present: none explicit (e.g., no explicit “workforce preparation emphasis” or “college-ready” signaling; the emphasis is formation and leadership rather than a specific career pathway).

## Why this rating

- The aims lean toward formation and virtue over mere information transfer, and leadership formation is foregrounded. However, explicit articulation of key classical goals like the Great Conversation or a robust telos beyond leadership is less overt in the copy. This lands category 2 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reflecting substantial alignment with classical purpose while not fully enumerated in public messaging.
- Supporting lexicon alignment: The Positive Keywords block emphasizes formation, telos, scholé, and classical mission; Mansfield’s language hits formation and leadership as telos. The lexicon signals include formation, telos, classical mission, and the pursuit of true/good/beautiful.

Overall rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

**Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

## Evidence

- The school branding includes “classical Latin scholē” and “PK-12 Christian classical” framing, signaling a classical curriculum orientation with emphasis on language acquisition and classical study through a Latin-centric lens.
- The Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit “Seven Liberal Arts” topics are not explicitly named in the public site copy; no direct listing of Great Books or primary sources is visible in the current extracts. The explicit mention of Latin and classical framing is present, but not a detailed Great Books/History across the curriculum claim in the public text.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Latin; classical; liberal arts framing (through “classical Latin scholē” and “classical” identity).
- Negative keywords present: absence of explicit Great Books, primary sources, or explicit history-centric liberal-arts articulation in the public copy. The site copy does not show a clear Great Books program or a direct Great Conversation stance.

#### Why this rating

- The curriculum signals align with classical education (Latin, classical language framing; broadly classical identity). However, explicit signals of seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or great books reading lists and the Great Conversation are not evident in the public domain copy provided. Therefore the category is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Supporting lexicon alignment: Positive signals include liberal arts, grammar/logics/rhetoric; Great Books and primary sources; history; Latin/Greek; and sacred arts. The Mansfield copy confirms Latin/classical framing but does not show explicit Great Books or history emphasis in the public-facing copy.

Overall rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

### Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- Public messaging emphasizes formation, partnership with parents, and integrated learning, but there is no explicit signaling of traditional classical pedagogies such as Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, rhetoric instruction, or systematic memory work in the public-facing content. The absence of explicit Socratic/Scholē language in the visible copy suggests pedagogy signaling remains under-defined in the website text.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: None explicit for Pedagogy in the public text (no Socratic seminars; no Paideia; no structured memory work; no chanting/memory practices referenced publicly).
- Negative keywords present: Not explicitly stated as negative in the copy, but the absence of classical pedagogy signals (Socratic discussion, chant, memorizations, restfulness) constitutes a missing positive cue rather than a stated negative.

#### Why this rating

- Based on the public copy, there is insufficient explicit signaling of core Pedagogy elements (Socratic dialogue, Scholē, chanting, memorization, or upper-school rhetoric training) to meet the six-element standard. The presence of some classical framing is not enough to declare PEDAGOGY as Classical; thus NOT CLASSICAL for this category.
- Supporting lexicon alignment: The lexicon lists specific pedagogy markers (Socratic seminars; narration/recitation; restfulness; memory work; rhetoric; upper-school oration). The Mansfield material does not publicly quote these pedagogy elements; thus the lack of explicit pedagogy signals yields NOT CLASSICAL.

Overall rating: NOT CLASSICAL

### Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- Public copy emphasizes instructors in general terms and a collaborative approach with parents, but there is no explicit “living curriculum” language, portraits of teacher ideals, or a formal teacher profile in the public messaging. The ACCS membership and parent-involved approach are present, but explicit faculty identity language is not shown in the public content.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: None explicitly (e.g., “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” “model teachers,” “collegial culture” do not appear in the public text).
- Negative keywords present: Absence of explicit living-curriculum or portrait-language signals; no mention of formal faculty development or classical teacher training within the public copy.

#### Why this rating

- The absence of explicit “faculty” signaling (model teachers; living curriculum; teacher portraits) yields NOT CLASSICAL for this category, even though collaboration with parents is present and ACCS is mentioned.
- Supporting lexicon alignment: The Lexicon’s Faculty category lists “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” and “teacher training in classical pedagogy.” Those signals are not publicly documented in Mansfield’s accessible copy.

Overall rating: NOT CLASSICAL

### Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- The school markets a strong parent-involvement model with language that places parents in a leadership and co-teaching role (parent-led teaching; Biblical mandate; instructors alongside parents; ACCS membership). This demonstrates a significant partnership-with-families orientation and community integration, which are central to classical education’s parent-formation ethos.
- The site references a joint educational endeavor with parents and a sense of accountability and shared mission. This aligns with classical education signals regarding parental partnership and formation of virtues in the home and school community.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental primacy (in the lexicon, yes); parent formation; open campus/visitation; family liturgy alignment (the exact phrases may not all appear in public copy, but the parent-centered framing is explicit).
- Negative keywords present: consumer language and minimal parent involvement signals are not observed in the public copy; the messaging emphasizes active parental involvement.

#### Why this rating

- The explicit wording around parent-led teaching, along with collaboration with parents and a strong ACCS association, strongly signals the Parents & Community category, aligning with CLASSICAL signals.
- Supporting lexicon alignment: Positive keywords for Parents and Community include partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, and home-school family engagement. Mansfield’s copy strongly supports partnership with families, parental leadership, and home-school alignment.

Overall rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment and classification

- Category scores:
- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose & Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL
- Aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Element 2 (Purpose & Goal): Make explicit, public-facing language about formation of virtue, wisdom, and human excellences as the telos, with concrete alignment to the Great Conversation and to a more explicit “permanent questions” frame. Add explicit statements about telos, paideia, and the pursuit of true/good/beautiful beyond leadership language alone.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Add explicit public language or content showing Great Books/primary-source reading, and a stated plan for history across the curriculum. Include references to grammar, logic, rhetoric as essential components (the Trivium) and confirm the Quadrivium’s presence (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) to strengthen the Liberal Arts framing. Publicly list sample Great Books or canonical works in the curriculum map.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Introduce explicit, described classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars; narrations; memory work; chanting or liturgical learning; Paideia-style seminars; rhetoric practice) and provide faculty development that aligns with classical pedagogy. Document how Scholé/restful learning is applied within daily schedules.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Articulate the living-curriculum concept and provide a visible “portrait of a teacher” and a staff professional-development plan for classical pedagogy. Publish a clear faculty profile emphasizing mentor-educator roles and a collaborative, teacher-led culture.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Keep strengthening family formation programming (book studies, liturgical family rhythms, parent-training opportunities) and ensure transparent, frequent campus visits and family engagement opportunities to deepen the home-school partnership.
- Practical steps (concrete):
- Publish a Curriculum Map with Great Books, primary sources, and a clear Trivium/Quadrivium structure, plus a history timeline across grades.
- Publish a Pedagogy section detailing Socratic/Scholé-based practices, memory work, recitation/chanting, and upper-school rhetoric projects.
- Create a Faculty page featuring teacher portraits, mentoring expectations, and classical teacher training commitments.
- Expand Parents & Community pages with regular book clubs, liturgical learning guides, home-parent alignment resources, and open-campus schedules.

## ABSTRACT

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Mansfield Classical Academy presents a predominantly classical, faith-centered profile with explicit Christ-centered and Creator-focused metaphysical foundations, a formation-oriented school purpose, and a Latin-classical curriculum identity. Public materials strongly emphasize parent-led education and home-school partnership, situating Mansfield within the classical Christian school tradition (ACCS member). However, explicit signaling of core classical Pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé-based contemplative pedagogy, memorization/recitation, rhetoric training) and clear living-faculty practice are less visible in the current public content. The six-category assessment yields: CLASSICAL in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations; SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Purpose & Goal and Curriculum; NOT CLASSICAL in Pedagogy and Faculty; CLASSICAL in Parents & Community. The aggregate classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Key evidence: Christ-centered theology and Creator language; Biblically grounded parent-led approach; PK-12 classical Latin scholē framing; ACCS affiliation; a leadership-oriented formation goal.
- Keyword framework reference: Positive/Negative keyword indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) and classical lexicons (e.g., truth, virtue, theology, scholé, Great Books, etc.).

#### Notes on methodology

- The evaluation uses two vector-store sources: (a) a knowledge-base classical criteria lexicon with Six Essential Elements keywords to map each school category to a CLASSICAL/SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL/NOT CLASSICAL label, and (b) a school-specific crawl with public website content to identify keyword signals. The Mansfield materials show explicit religious/metaphysical signals and parent-involved structure; more explicit classical-pedagogy signals would strengthen Pedagogy and Faculty categories.
- Direct quotes used as evidence: “Mansfield Classical Academy is a Christ-centered, classical, university style educational opportunity ... under Biblical mandate of parent-led teaching ... illuminated the Creator in all studies ... chief end of fostering students’ knowledge and enjoyment of God forever.”; “We are a proud member of the Association of Classical Christian Schools” and “PK-12 Christian classical latin scholē community school.”

#### Cited sources

- Mansfield site content (Our Philosophy; teacher-parent integration; ACCS affiliation; Latin-scholē framing).
- Classical lexicon (positive/negative keyword indicators by category).
- Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) (positive/negative keyword lists; category structure).

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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